

Sam Hayek

Design engineer + creative generalist

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10+ years of building identities, shipping products, and growing communities for startups.

EXPERIENCE

Designer

FEB 2024 - PRESENT

Freelance • AI, Web3, Music, and more.

Brand identities, websites, and product design for early-stage companies.

- Arcarae** — Brand expansion and visual design for an AI self-reflection app
- Grow Theory** — Design engineering (landing page) for AI ops consulting company
- Arete** — Brand identity and landing page for construction services company
- Parallel** — Brand identity and product design for an AI video editing tool
- GasHawk** — Landing page for an Ethereum gas optimization platform
- ChargedParticles** — Website and product design for Web3 Packs and Phoenix Guild
- Fanfly** — Branding and product design for a Web3 music live-streaming mobile app
- Project Legacy** — Brand identity, landing page, and custom icons for a health community
- Additional** — Winery (brand/label), Plumbing company (print/web), Web3 gaming (social posts)

Founder

MAR 2022 - SEPT 2023

Headphone Homies

Built brand, led creative direction, and product design from concept to launch.

- Design** — Created brand system, led creative direction, designed mint site (react/polygon)
- Growth** — Built community to 20k followers on X, and 3K members on Discord
- BD** — Secured partnerships with Magic Eden, Polygon, Decent, and Unchained Music
- Other** — Hosted weekly X spaces with up to 300 listeners, generated \$5k in NFT sales

Designer & Community Lead

2021 - 2022

Web3 Music Platforms

Created social media content, designed merch, and managed communities (Discord/Telegram).

- SoundXYZ** — Supported growth for a16z-backed music NFT platform during closed beta
- Audius** — Platform grew from 3M-6M monthly users and announced TikTok partnership

PROJECTS

- Sentience** sentience-home.vercel.app/portal
Redesigning an AI product's home surface (Mac OS app)
- Arcarae** arcarae-case-study.vercel.app
Brand expansion case study for AI self-reflection (iOS app)
- Oasis** github.com/samhayek-code/oasis
macOS utility that automatically organizes downloads into a clean (daily, weekly, monthly) hierarchy with file categorization
- Baseline** baseline-beta.vercel.app
Design tool for generating customizable grid overlays with canvas presets, line styles, and png / svg export

SKILLS

- Design**
Branding, Design Engineering, Creative Direction, Visual Design, Product
- Tools**
Figma, Claude Code, Procreate, Cursor, Flora, Adobe, Framer, Paper, Pencil, DaVinci Resolve, Ableton, and more...
- Code**
HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Three.js, WGSL, Motion
- Other**
Content Strategy, Social Media Marketing, Community Management, Audio Engineering, Video Editing, Copywriting